IMPARTIAL ANALYSIS OF
MEASURE C2026
CITY OF SANTA MARIA

The Santa Maria City Council has placed Measure C2026 on the ballot to ask the voters of Santa Maria if the City should enact a local one-half (1/2) cent sales tax. The sales tax is also called a transactions and use tax. The City currently collects a local one (1) cent sales tax under the previously adopted Measure U. If approved by the voters, this local one-half (1/2) cent sales tax would be collected in the same manner as the existing local one (1) cent sales tax. The proposed increased local sales tax would continue until repealed by the voters of the City.

As a general local tax approved by the voters of Santa Maria, Measure C2026's revenue must be placed in the City's general fund and used for general governmental purposes. It is estimated that Measure C2026 will provide an additional $13 million in annual local funding that could be used to maintain and enhance community services including parks and recreation, the aquatic center, library, youth programs, and roads and streets. The State cannot take the revenue from Measure C2026 for its own use.

Measure C2026 would require annual independent audits to account for the tax revenues received and expenditures made in relation to the local one-half (1/2) cent sales tax. Such audits will be provided to the City Council for their review.

A "Yes" vote is a vote to approve the local one-half (1/2) cent sales tax. A "No" vote is a vote against the local one-half (1/2) cent sales tax. Measure C2026 will be approved if it receives a simple majority of "Yes" votes.

The above statement is an impartial analysis of Measure C2026. If you desire a copy of Measure C2026, please call the Santa Maria City Clerk's Office at (805) 925-0951, extension 2306, and a copy will be mailed at no cost to you.

Respectfully submitted,

/s/ Thomas T. Watson
City Attorney

ARGUMENT IN FAVOR OF
MEASURE C2026
CITY OF SANTA MARIA

Santa Maria is an amazing place to live with many wonderful community amenities and with more opportunities for the future. Voting Yes on Measure C will keep the City's future bright, by ensuring local funds for high-quality programs and amenities that serve our residents and businesses.

Ultimately, a vote for Measure C is a vote to support our Community!

This would generate $13,000,000 in taxpayer dollars that are locally-controlled, and cannot be taken away from the State, and will be subject to mandatory, independent financial audits and Citizen Oversight, ensuring that every dollar is spent as promised.

Yes on Measure C will give our youth opportunities to succeed, keep them out of gangs, and promote safe communities.

Yes on Measure C will give adults and seniors more programs and services that will enrich quality of life.

Yes on Measure C will keep City recreational facilities open year-round, including our parks and aquatic center.

Yes on Measure C will allow for more hours to access the public library.

Yes on Measure C will set aside local funding for street and road repairs and ensure well-maintained roads.

Yes on Measure C will allow the City to qualify for our fair share of millions in matching grants, ensuring taxpayers don't have to pay the full cost of our programs and services.

Join a unanimous Santa Maria City Council, public safety officers, business and community leaders in voting YES on C.

/s/ Alice M. Patino
Mayor, City of Santa Maria
/s/ Gloria Flores
Mayor Pro Tem, District 2
/s/ Maribel Aguilera
Council Member, District 4
/s/ Richard Batalla
Council Member, District 1
/s/ Gloria Soto
Council Member District 3

NO ARGUMENT AGAINST
MEASURE C2026 WAS FILED

FULL TEXT OF

MEASURE C2026

CITY OF SANTA MARIA

AN ORDINANCE OF THE CITY OF SANTA MARIA, CALIFORNIA, ADDING CHAPTER 3-8B IMPOSING A TRANSACTIONS AND USE TAX TO BE ADMINISTERED BY THE DEPARTMENT OF TAX AND FEE ADMINISTRATION

WHEREAS, recent polling shows that a large majority of residents expressed high satisfaction with the City's delivery services; and

WHEREAS, recent polling and community input also show that residents are concerned with quality of life issues facing Santa Maria; and

WHEREAS, the City remains committed in delivering high-quality services to the community's residents and in addressing the expressed concerns of the community; and

WHEREAS, locally-controlled funding is more necessary now than ever to continue to support the City's efforts to provide the full-range of services, including but not limited to, parks and recreation, including the aquatic center, library, youth programs, and improving the City's roads and streets; and

WHEREAS, this measure will give Santa Maria local control over local funds for local needs. No funds can be taken by Sacramento; and

WHEREAS, the City must ensure delivery of high-quality services to the community and to address the concerns identified by community residents; and

WHEREAS, a secure source of local funding is needed to maintain recreational facilities, including the aquatic center, and programs focused on at-risk youth, anti-gang outreach coordination, and after-school programs that keep the City's kids safe, off the streets, and out of trouble; and

WHEREAS, resources are needed to address public improvements, including maintenance of the City's streets and roadways; and

WHEREAS, expanding local funding will qualify Santa Maria to receive its fair share of millions of dollars in matching grants, so taxpayers do not have to pay the entire cost of critical programs.

BE IT ORDAINED BY THE CITY COUNCIL OF THE CITY OF SANTA MARIA, AS FOLLOWS:

SECTION 1. Chapter 3-8B of Title 3 of the Santa Maria Municipal Code is hereby added to read as follows:

CHAPTER 3-8B CITY SERVICES TRANSACTIONS AND USE TAX

Section 3-8B.01. Title.
This Chapter shall be known as the "City Services Transactions and Use Tax Code." The City of Santa Maria hereinafter shall be called "City." This Chapter shall be applicable in the incorporated territory of the City.

Section 3-8B.02. Operative Date.
"Operative Date" means the first day of the first calendar quarter commencing more than 110 days after adoption of this Chapter, the date of such adoption being August 4, 2026.

Section 3-8B.03. Purpose.
This Chapter is adopted to achieve the following, among other purposes, and directs that the provisions hereof be interpreted in order to accomplish those purposes:

(a) To impose a retail transactions and use tax in accordance with the provisions of Part 1.6 (commencing with Section 7251) of Division 2 of the Revenue and Taxation Code and Section 7285.9 of Part 1.7 of Division 2 which authorizes the City to adopt this tax which shall be operative if a 50% and 1 vote of the electors voting on the measure vote to approve the imposition of the tax at an election called for that purpose.

(b) To adopt a retail transactions and use tax that incorporates provisions identical to those of the Sales and Use Tax Law of the State of California insofar as those provisions are not inconsistent with the requirements and limitations contained in Part 1.6 of Division 2 of the Revenue and Taxation Code.

(c) To adopt a retail transactions and use tax that imposes a tax and provides a measure therefore that can be administered and collected by the California Department of Tax and Fee Administration in a manner that adapts itself as fully as practicable to, and requires the least possible deviation from, the existing statutory and administrative procedures followed by the California Department of Tax and Fee Administration in administering and collecting the California State Sales and Use Taxes.

(d) To adopt a retail transactions and use tax that can be administered in a manner that will be, to the greatest degree possible, consistent with the provisions of Part 1.6 of Division 2 of the Revenue and Taxation Code, minimize the cost of collecting the transactions and use taxes, and at the same time, minimize the burden of recordkeeping upon persons subject to taxation under the provisions of this ordinance.

Section 3-8B.04. Contract with State.

Prior to the operative date, the City shall contract with the California Department of Tax and Fee Administration to perform all functions incident to the administration and operation of this transactions and use tax; provided, that if the City shall not have contracted with the California Department of Tax and Fee Administration prior to the operative date, it shall nevertheless so contract and in such a case the operative date shall be the first day of the first calendar quarter following the execution of such a contract.

Section 3-8B.05. Transactions Tax Rate.

For the privilege of selling tangible personal property at retail, a tax is hereby imposed upon all retailers in the incorporated territory of the City at the rate of 0.5% of the gross receipts of any retailer from the sale of all tangible personal property sold at retail in said territory on and after the operative date of this Chapter. This tax is in addition to the tax imposed by Chapter 3-8A of this code.

Section 3-8B.06. Place of Sale.

For the purposes of this Chapter, all retail sales are consummated at the place of business of the retailer unless the tangible personal property sold is delivered by the retailer or his agent to an out-of-state destination or to a common carrier for delivery to an out-of-state destination. The gross receipts from such sales shall include delivery charges, when such charges are subject to the state sales and use tax, regardless of the place to which delivery is made. In the event a retailer has no permanent place of business in the State or has more than one place of business, the place or places at which the retail sales are consummated shall be determined under rules and regulations to be prescribed and adopted by the California Department of Tax and Fee Administration.

Section 3-8B.07. Use Tax Rate.

An excise tax is hereby imposed on the storage, use or other consumption in the City of tangible personal property purchased from any retailer on and after the operative date of this Chapter for storage, use or other consumption in said territory at the rate of 0.5% of the sales price of the property. This tax is in addition to the tax imposed by Chapter 3-8A of this code. The sales price shall include delivery charges when such charges are subject to state sales or use tax regardless of the place to which delivery is made.

Section 3-8B.08. Adoption of Provisions of State Law.

Except as otherwise provided in this Chapter and except insofar as they are inconsistent with the provisions of Part 1.6 of Division 2 of the Revenue and Taxation Code, all of the provisions of Part 1 (commencing with Section 6001) of Division 2 of the Revenue and Taxation Code are hereby adopted and made a part of this Chapter as though fully set forth herein.

Section 3-8B.09. Limitations on Adoption of State Law and Collection of Use Taxes.

In adopting the provisions of Part 1 of Division 2 of the Revenue and Taxation Code:

(a) Wherever the State of California is named or referred to as the taxing agency, the name of this City shall be substituted therefore. However, the substitution shall not be made when:

(1) The word "State" is used as a part of the title of the State Controller, State Treasurer, State Treasury, or the Constitution of the State of California;

(2) The result of that substitution would require action to be taken by or against this City or any agency, officer, or employee thereof rather than by or against the California Department of Tax and Fee Administration, in performing the functions incident to the administration or operation of this Chapter.

(3) In those sections, including, but not necessarily limited to sections referring to the exterior boundaries of the State of California, where the result of the substitution would be to:

(A) Provide an exemption from this tax with respect to certain sales, storage, use or other consumption of tangible personal property which would not otherwise be exempt from this tax while such sales, storage, use or other consumption remain subject to tax by the State under the provisions of Part 1 of Division 2 of the Revenue and Taxation Code, or;

(B) Impose this tax with respect to certain sales, storage, use or other consumption of tangible personal property which would not be subject to tax by the state under the said provision of that code.

(4) In Sections 6701, 6702 (except in the last sentence thereof), 6711, 6715, 6737, 6797 or 6828 of the Revenue and Taxation Code.

(b) The word "City" shall be substituted for the word "State" in the phrase "retailer engaged in business in this State" in Section 6203 and in the definition of that phrase in Section 6203.

Section 3-8B.10. Permit Not Required.

If a seller's permit has been issued to a retailer under Section 6067 of the Revenue and Taxation Code, an additional transactor's permit shall not be required by this Chapter.

Section 3-8B.11. Exemptions and Exclusions.

(a) There shall be excluded from the measure of the transactions tax and the use tax the amount of any sales tax or use tax imposed by the State of California or by any city, city and county, or county pursuant to the Bradley-Burns Uniform Local Sales and Use Tax Law or the amount of any state-administered transactions or use tax.

(b) There are exempted from the computation of the amount of transactions tax the gross receipts from:

(1) Sales of tangible personal property, other than fuel or petroleum products, to operators of aircraft to be used or consumed principally outside the county in which the sale is made and directly and exclusively in the use of such aircraft as common carriers of persons or property under the authority of the laws of this State, the United States, or any foreign government.

(2) Sales of property to be used outside the City which is shipped to a point outside the City, pursuant to the contract of sale, by delivery to such point by the retailer or his agent, or by delivery by the retailer to a carrier for shipment to a consignee at such point. For the purposes of this Section, delivery to a point outside the City shall be satisfied:

(A) With respect to vehicles (other than commercial vehicles) subject to registration pursuant to Chapter 1 (commencing with Section 4000) of Division 3 of the Vehicle Code, aircraft licensed in compliance with Section 21411 of the Public Utilities Code, and undocumented vessels registered under Division 3 .5 (commencing with Section 9840) of the Vehicle Code by registration to an out-of-City address and by a declaration under penalty of perjury, signed by the buyer, stating that such address is, in fact, his or her principal place of residence; and

(B) With respect to commercial vehicles, by registration to a place of business out-of-City and declaration under penalty of perjury, signed by the buyer, that the vehicle will be operated from that address.

(3) The sale of tangible personal property if the seller is obligated to furnish the property for a fixed price pursuant to a contract entered into prior to the operative date of this Chapter.

(4) A lease of tangible personal property which is a continuing sale of such property, for any period of time for which the leaser is obligated to lease the property for an amount fixed by the lease prior to the operative date of this Chapter.

(5) For the purposes of subparagraphs (3) and (4) of this Section, the sale or lease of tangible personal property shall be deemed not to be obligated pursuant to a contract or lease for any period of time for which any party to the contract or lease has the unconditional right to terminate the contract or lease upon notice, whether or not such right is exercised.

(c) There are exempted from the use tax imposed by this Chapter, the storage, use or other consumption in this City of tangible personal property:

(1) The gross receipts from the sale of which have been subject to a transactions tax under any state-administered transactions and use tax.

(2) Other than fuel or petroleum products purchased by operators of aircraft and used or consumed by such operators directly and exclusively in the use of such aircraft as common carriers of persons or property for hire or compensation under a certificate of public convenience and necessity issued pursuant to the laws of this State, the United States, or any foreign government. This exemption is in addition to the exemptions provided in Sections 6366 and 6366.1 of the Revenue and Taxation Code of the State of California.

(3) If the purchaser is obligated to purchase the property for a fixed price pursuant to a contract entered into prior to the operative date of this Chapter.

(4) If the possession of, or the exercise of any right or power over, the tangible personal property arises under a lease which is a continuing purchase of such property for any period of time for which the lessee is obligated to lease the property for an amount fixed by a lease prior to the operative date of this Chapter.

(5) For the purposes of subparagraphs (3) and (4) of this Section, storage, use, or other consumption, or possession of, or exercise of any right or power over, tangible personal property shall be deemed not to be obligated pursuant to a contract or lease for any period of time for which any party to the contract or lease has the unconditional right to terminate the contract or lease upon notice, whether or not such right is exercised.

(6) Except as provided in subparagraph (7), a retailer engaged in business in the City shall not be required to collect use tax from the purchaser of tangible personal property, unless the retailer ships or delivers the property into the City or participates within the City in making the sale of the property, including, but not limited to, soliciting or receiving the order, either directly or indirectly, at a place of business of the retailer in the City or through any representative, agent, canvasser, solicitor, subsidiary, or person in the City under the authority of the retailer.

(7) "A retailer engaged in business in the City" shall also include any retailer of any of the following: vehicles subject to registration pursuant to Chapter 1 (commencing with Section 4000) of Division 3 of the Vehicle Code, aircraft licensed in compliance with Section 21411 of the Public Utilities Code, or undocumented vessels registered under Division 3.5 (commencing with Section 9840) of the Vehicle Code. That retailer shall be required to collect use tax from any purchaser who registers or licenses the vehicle, vessel, or aircraft at an address in the City.

(d) Any person subject to use tax under this Chapter may credit against that tax any transactions tax or reimbursement for transactions tax paid to a district imposing, or retailer liable for a transactions tax pursuant to Part 1.6 of Division 2 of the Revenue and Taxation Code with respect to the sale to the person of the property the storage, use or other consumption of which is subject to the use tax.

Section 3-8B.12. Amendments.
All amendments subsequent to the effective date of this Chapter to Part 1 of Division 2 of the Revenue and Taxation Code relating to sales and use taxes and which are not inconsistent with Part 1.6 and Part 1.7 of Division 2 of the Revenue and Taxation Code, and all amendments to Part 1.6 and Part 1.7 of Division 2 of the Revenue and Taxation Code, shall automatically become a part of this Chapter, provided however, that no such amendment shall operate so as to affect the rate of tax imposed by this Chapter.

Section 3-8B.13. Enjoining Collection Forbidden.
No injunction or writ of mandate or other legal or equitable process shall issue in any suit, action or proceeding in any court against the State or the City, or against any officer of the State or the City, to prevent or enjoin the collection under this ordinance, or Part 1.6 of Division 2 of the Revenue and Taxation Code, of any tax or any amount of tax required to be collected.

Section 3-8B.14. Annual Independent Audits.
The City shall ensure that annual independent audits are conducted to account for the tax revenues received and expenditures made in relation to the 0.5% transaction and use tax. Such audits will be provided to the City Council for their review.

Section 3-8B.15. Termination Date.
The authority to levy the tax imposed by this Chapter shall expire when ended by the voters of the City.

SECTION 2. USE OF TAX PROCEEDS. The proceeds of the tax approved by this Ordinance may be used for unrestricted general revenue purposes.

SECTION 3. SEVERABILITY. If any provision of this Ordinance or the application thereof to any person or circumstances is determined by a competent court to be invalid, the remainder of the Ordinance and the application of such provision to other persons or circumstances shall not be affected thereby.

SECTION 4. ELECTION REQUIRED. This Ordinance shall not become operative unless and until a 50% and 1 vote of the electors voting on this measure vote to approve the imposition of the tax at the General Election to be held on November 3, 2026.

SECTION 5. EFFECTIVE DATE. This Ordinance relates to the levying and collecting of the City transaction and use taxes and shall take effect immediately.

SECTION 6. COMPLIANCE WITH THE CALIFORNIA ENVIRONMENTAL QUALITY ACT. This Ordinance has been reviewed for compliance with the California Environmental Quality Act (CEQA), and the CEQA guidelines, and the City's environmental procedures and determined not to be a "Project" under CEQA. Section 15378(b)(4) of the CEQA Guidelines states a Project does not include the creation of government funding mechanisms or other government fiscal activities which do not involve any commitment to any specific project which may result in a potentially significant physical impact on the environment. The transactions and use tax imposed by the adoption of this Ordinance is a general tax that can be used for any legitimate governmental purpose; it is not a commitment to any particular action. Accordingly, the Ordinance is not a Project under CEQA. Furthermore, even if the Ordinance was a Project, it would be exempt pursuant to § 15061(b)(3) (common sense) of the CEQA Guidelines, which provides that a Project is exempt if it can be seen with certainty that there is no possibility that the activity in question may have a significant physical impact on the environment. The City Council hereby finds with certainty that there is no possibility the passage of this Ordinance will have a significant physical impact on the environment because the Ordinance is not a commitment to any particular action. If revenue from the tax were used for a purpose that would have such a potential for physical impact, the City would undertake any required CEQA review for that particular project at the earliest feasible date.

SECTION 7. CLERICAL CORRECTION. The Chief Deputy City Clerk is hereby authorized to make minor changes herein to address clerical errors, so long as substantial conformance of the intent of this document is maintained. In doing so, the Chief Deputy City Clerk shall consult with the City Manager and City Attorney concerning any changes deemed necessary.

Sample Ballot

Ballot Type 73

SAMPLE BALLOT

NOVEMBER 3, 2026, GENERAL ELECTION

B

COUNTY OF SANTA BARBARA

MEASURES SUBMITTED TO THE VOTERS

STATE

PROPOSITION 1
AUTHORIZES BONDS FOR HOUSING AFFORDABILITY PROGRAMS. LEGISLATIVE STATUTE. Authorizes $11.25 billion in state general obligation bonds for housing affordability programs, including multifamily rental housing, mortgages for veterans, supportive housing, preservation of existing affordable housing, and downpayment assistance.
Fiscal Impact: Increased state cost of $500 million to $600 million annually for about 25 years to repay the housing bond.
Supporters: US Vets; CA Federation of Teachers; Self-Help for the Elderly; Habitat for Humanity CA; CA Alliance of Child & Family Services
Opponents: None submitted

YES ◯
NO ◯

PROPOSITION 2
INCREASES STATE'S RAINY DAY FUND. LEGISLATIVE CONSTITUTIONAL AMENDMENT. Increases California's Rainy Day Fund, approved by voters in 2014, to provide funding for education, health care, public safety, and other essential services during economic downturns.
Fiscal Impact: State budget reserves would be higher.
Supporters: CA Professional Firefighters; LA Chamber of Commerce; Gavin Newsom; Xavier Becerra; Assemblymember Jesse Gabriel
Opponents: None submitted

YES ◯
NO ◯

PROPOSITION 3
PROVIDES PERMANENT FUNDING FOR SCHOOLS AND HEALTH CARE BY EXTENDING EXISTING TAX ON HIGH INCOMES. INITIATIVE CONSTITUTIONAL AMENDMENT. Makes permanent existing voter-approved tax rates for individuals earning over $371,000 (adjusted annually for inflation). Allocates tax revenues to public education.
Fiscal Impact: Maintains $5 billion to $15 billion of annual state income tax revenue by making a temporary tax increase on high-income earners permanent instead of letting it expire in 2031.
Supporters: California Teachers Association; CA School Nurses Organization; California State PTA; Planned Parenthood Affiliates of CA
Opponents: California Taxpayers Association; Family Business Association of California; California Hispanic Chambers of Commerce

YES ◯
NO ◯

PROPOSITION 4
REPEALS PROHIBITION AGAINST PUBLIC FUNDING OF ELECTION CAMPAIGNS. LEGISLATIVE STATUTE. Repeals prohibition on state and local governments offering public funding of candidate election campaigns. Public funding programs may not use funds earmarked for education, transportation, or public safety.
Fiscal Impact: Ongoing costs to the state of a few hundred thousand dollars each year for the Fair Political Practices Commission to answer questions from state and local governments about public campaign finance programs.
Supporters: League of Women Voters of CA; California Nurses Association; Mental Health Advocacy; Social Security Works; Consumer Watchdog
Opponents: California Taxpayers Assn; Howard Jarvis Taxpayers Assn; Family Business Assn of California; United Latinos Action

YES ◯
NO ◯

PROPOSITION 5
CHANGES RECALL ELECTION PROCESS FOR STATEWIDE OFFICERS. LEGISLATIVE CONSTITUTIONAL AMENDMENT. Under current law, voters elect replacement candidates at the same time as the recall election. This measure instead fills recall vacancies by subsequent special election or appointment.
Fiscal Impact: Net fiscal effect unknown. In the event of a recall, savings or costs of millions of dollars to administer the election depending on the office recalled.
Supporters: None submitted
Opponents: None submitted

YES ◯
NO ◯

PROPOSITION 37
CREATES LOAN PROGRAM FOR MIDDLE-INCOME BUYERS OF QUALIFIED NEW HOMES. INITIATIVE STATUTE. Authorizes $25 billion in bonds to offer eligible buyers fixed-rate mortgages for up to 17% of purchase price of a newly constructed home priced below about $1.5 million. Borrowers must be California residents, occupy the home, meet income limits, and pay at least 3% down. Bonds repaid by mortgage payments, not State.
Fiscal Impact: No direct state or local costs.
Supporters: United Nurses Associations of California; California Conference of Carpenters; California State Treasurer Fiona Ma
Opponents: None submitted

YES ◯
NO ◯

PROPOSITION 38
AUTHORIZES BONDS FOR IMMUNOLOGY MEDICAL RESEARCH. INITIATIVE STATUTE. Authorizes $8.4 billion in general obligation bonds for immunology and immunotherapy research, half to a single University of California-affiliated nonprofit medical research institute, half to research grants.
Fiscal Impact: Increased state cost of $500 million to $600 million annually for about 20 years to repay the research bond, with some or all of the cost offset if the funded research generates revenue.
Supporters: Michael J. Fox Foundation; Alzheimer's Los Angeles; Kidney Cancer Assoc; American Nurses Assoc\CA
Opponents: Robert M Kaplan Ph.D.

YES ◯
NO ◯

PROPOSITION 39
PROHIBITS CITIZENS FROM VOTING UNLESS THEY PRESENT GOVERNMENT-ISSUED IDENTIFICATION. INITIATIVE CONSTITUTIONAL AMENDMENT. Invalidates mail ballots that do not have last four digits of designated government-issued identification number written on envelope. Prohibits in-person voting without presenting government-issued identification.
Fiscal Impact: Costs of between tens of millions of dollars and low hundreds of millions of dollars each year to implement new voting requirements.
Supporters: The Transparency Foundation; Latino American Political Assn; Howard Jarvis Taxpayers Assn; CA Women's Leadership Assn
Opponents: ACLU California Action; Common Cause; League of Women Voters of California

YES ◯
NO ◯

PROPOSITION 40
IMPOSES ONE-TIME TAX ON CERTAIN TAXPAYERS. INITIATIVE CONSTITUTIONAL AMENDMENT AND STATUTE. Imposes 5% tax on certain taxpayers with assets over $1 billion; revenue primarily for health care. Exempts revenues from constitutional requirements for school funding and spending limit.
Fiscal Impact: Temporary revenue increase of tens of billions of dollars spread over several years from wealth tax on billionaires. Possible ongoing decrease of less than $1 billion per year in income tax revenue from billionaires.
Supporters: US Senator Bernie Sanders; SEIU United Healthcare Workers West
Opponents: California Primary Care Association; California School Boards Association; California Taxpayers Association

YES ◯
NO ◯

PROPOSITION 41
PROHIBITS NEW STATE TAXES THAT EXCLUDE REVENUES FROM STATE SPENDING LIMIT. REQUIRES AUDITS FOR NEW STATE SPECIAL TAXES. INITIATIVE CONSTITUTIONAL AMENDMENT. Nullifies state taxes enacted after January 1, 2026 that exempt their revenues from voter-approved state spending limit. Requires pre-election and recurring audits of programs funded by new special taxes.
Fiscal Impact: The net fiscal effect is unknown as it depends on future decisions by voters, the Legislature, and other policymakers.
Supporters: CA Society of Certified Public Accountants (CalCPAs); CalAsian Chamber of Commerce; California Taxpayers Association (CalTax)
Opponents: US Senator Bernie Sanders; SEIU United Healthcare Workers West

YES ◯
NO ◯

PROPOSITION 42
PROHIBITS NEW STATE PERSONAL PROPERTY TAXES AND CERTAIN RETROACTIVE STATE TAXES. INITIATIVE CONSTITUTIONAL AMENDMENT. Prohibits any new state tax (1) imposed on the ownership of personal property (all things people own other than real estate), or (2) that applies retroactively based on taxpayer's past activities. Nullifies taxes enacted after January 1, 2026 that conflict with this measure.
Fiscal Impact: Possibility that tax revenues will not go up as much in the future.
Supporters: CA Professional Firefighters; State Building & Construction Trades Council of CA; AMVETS Department of CA
Opponents: US Senator Bernie Sanders; SEIU United Healthcare Workers West

YES ◯
NO ◯

PROPOSITION 43
LIMITS VOTERS' ABILITY TO RAISE REVENUES FOR LOCAL GOVERNMENT SERVICES. LEGISLATIVE CONSTITUTIONAL AMENDMENT. Limits voters' ability to pass voter-proposed local special taxes by increasing percentage of votes needed to approve such ballot measures from a majority (over 50%) to two-thirds, beginning January 1, 2027.
Fiscal Impact: Possibility that local government tax revenues will not go up as much in the future due to a higher vote threshold for certain taxes.
Supporters: California Taxpayers Association; Family Business Association of California; California Hispanic Chambers of Commerce
Opponents: California Professional Firefighters; California Federation of Teachers; Nurse Alliance of SEIU CA.

YES ◯
NO ◯

CARD "B" This is ballot card 2 of 2

Sample Ballot

MEASURES SUBMITTED TO THE VOTERS

STATE

PROPOSITION 44
REQUIRES COMMUNITY HEALTH CLINICS SPEND 90% OF REVENUE ON PROGRAM SERVICES. INITIATIVE STATUTE. Imposes penalties on nonprofit Federally Qualified Health Centers (community clinics providing primary care to medically underserved areas and populations) that spend less than 90% of revenue on "program services" advancing their charitable purpose, including but not limited to patient services.
Fiscal Impact: Increased state costs in the low tens of millions of dollars per year, covered by fees.
Supporters: None submitted
Opponents: American Academy of Pediatrics CA; CA School Nurses Org; CA Academy of Family Physicians; CA Medical Assoc.

YES ◯

NO ◯

PROPOSITION 45
MODIFIES ENVIRONMENTAL REVIEW FOR CERTAIN PROJECTS. INITIATIVE STATUTE. Amends California Environmental Quality Act (CEQA) to expedite environmental review for certain projects (including most housing, transportation, water, and health projects) by setting deadlines to complete environmental review and resolve lawsuits challenging project approvals.
Fiscal Impact: Initial costs for state and local governments, likely in the high tens of millions of dollars—potentially exceeding $100 million—annually, partly covered by fees. Uncertain, potentially more significant positive or negative longer-term fiscal effects.
Supporters: California Children's Hospital Association; California Water Association; California Council for Affordable Housing
Opponents: Coalition for Clean Air; CA Environmental Voters; Physicians for Social Responsibility, LA; National Wildlife Federation

YES ◯

NO ◯

SCHOOL

ALLAN HANCOCK JOINT COMMUNITY COLLEGE DISTRICT

MEASURE H2026
ALLAN HANCOCK JOINT COMMUNITY COLLEGE DISTRICT AFFORDABLE HIGHER EDUCATION. To repair/ upgrade Allan Hancock College's aging classrooms, labs, career training facilities; construct classrooms, improve affordable education for students/veterans in science, math, nursing, welding, machining, skilled trades; offer local four-year degrees with Cal-Poly partnership; fix roofs, plumbing, electrical; and remove asbestos; shall Allan Hancock College's measure authorizing $290 million in bonds at legal rates be adopted, levying $19 /$100,000 assessed value ($16 million annually while bonds are outstanding), with citizen oversight of locally controlled funding?

BONDS-YES ◯

BONDS-NO ◯

CITY

CITY OF SANTA MARIA

MEASURE C2026
CITY OF SANTA MARIA GENERAL SERVICES. Maintain and enhance community services including parks and recreation, the aquatic center, library, youth programs, and roads and streets, to improve quality of life; shall the measure be approved adopting an ordinance implementing Measure C2026 at the one-half cent rate until ended by voters, providing $13,000,000 annually that cannot be taken by Sacramento, requiring oversight, independent audits, with all funds used locally.

YES ◯

NO ◯

CARD "B" This is ballot card 2 of 2